TO THE SKY

FREE GUIDE

Connect Claude to Google Analytics 4

The setup I use at my agency. You ask questions about your data in plain English, and Claude answers from your GA4 property: channels, funnels, conversions.

Inside: what you need · 3 setup steps · the questions I ask every week · prompts to copy · the traps I hit

WHAT YOU GET

Ask your data a question. Get an answer, not a report.

Once it's connected, Claude can:

- show which channel brings first-time buyers, and which one closes the sale
- build a funnel and tell you where people drop
- compare GA4 conversions with Google Ads for the same days
- check traffic sources, including the "unassigned" part
- look at realtime data right after you change a tag

The connector

Google Analytics MCP	The official connector from Google, free and open source. It is read-only: Claude reads and reports, it can't change anything in your property.
What it can read	Account and property details, standard and custom reports, realtime, funnels, conversions, Google Ads links, custom dimensions and annotations.

What you need

- Claude Code (in the terminal, or the Code tab of the Claude desktop app)
- Viewer access to the GA4 property (read access is enough)
- Python with pipx, and the Google Cloud CLI (gcloud)
- About 30 minutes, once

STEP 1 · GOOGLE CLOUD

Turn on the Analytics APIs

You do this once, in a Google Cloud project.

1. Go to **console.cloud.google.com** and create a project (any name).
2. In **APIs & Services → Library**, enable **Google Analytics Data API** and **Google Analytics Admin API**.
3. In **OAuth consent screen**, set it up for your own account.
4. In **Credentials → Create credentials → OAuth client ID**, choose **Desktop app** and download the JSON file.

> **Publish the consent screen to Production.** In Testing mode Google expires your access after 7 days and the connector stops working.

> Read-only is all you need. The connector asks only for the `analytics.readonly` scope.

STEP 2 · SIGN IN

Give the connector your Google access

The connector uses Application Default Credentials. One command, with the JSON file from Step 1:

```
gcloud auth application-default login --scopes https://www.googleapis.com/auth/analytics.readonly,https://www.googleapis.com/auth/cloud-platform --client-id-file=[your JSON file]
```

A browser window opens. Sign in with the Google account that can see your GA4 property and approve.

STEP 3 · CONNECT TO CLAUDE

Add the connector

Follow the README of **googleanalytics/google-analytics-mcp**. It runs with `pipx run analytics-mcp` and needs two settings: the path to your credentials file and your Google Cloud project ID.

Restart Claude and test it:

TEST

List my GA4 accounts and properties.

PROMPTS TO COPY

The questions I ask every week

FIRST CHANNEL

Which channel brings first-time buyers in the last 90 days? Show the share of first purchases by first user channel.

FUNNEL

Build a funnel: product view, add to cart, begin checkout, purchase. Where is the biggest drop, and is it worse on mobile?

ADS VS GA4

Compare GA4 conversions with Google Ads for the last 30 days, campaign by campaign. Where do they disagree?

UNASSIGNED

How much traffic is "Unassigned" this month, and which source/medium values cause it?

LANDING PAGES

Which landing pages from paid traffic have the lowest conversion rate?

REALTIME CHECK

I just changed a tag. Do you see purchase or generate_lead events in realtime?

WEEKLY SUMMARY

Give me a short summary of last week vs the week before: what moved, and why it matters.

REPORT

Turn that into 5 bullets I can send to a client, in plain language.

READ THE ANSWERS RIGHT

Why GA4 and Google Ads rarely match

- **Attribution:** each tool gives credit differently, so the same sale can sit in different channels.
- **Dates:** Google Ads counts a conversion on the click date, GA4 on the event date.
- **Consent:** visitors who refuse cookies show up differently in each tool.
- **Delay:** GA4 needs 24 to 48 hours to process data. Ask about complete days.

> Ask Claude for the reason behind a gap, not only the gap. Then check one number by hand in GA4 before you act on it.

> **It doesn't know your business.** A drop that looks bad can be a season, a sold-out product or a test. You decide what the numbers mean.

BEFORE YOU START

Traps I hit, so you don't

- **"This app is blocked".** Agency or Workspace accounts can block a personal OAuth app. For many properties, use a service account and add it as Viewer in GA4.
- **Consent screen left in Testing.** Access expired after 7 days. Publish it to Production.
- **New connector not showing up.** Claude only loads it after a restart.
- **Asking about today.** Today's data isn't complete yet. Ask about full days.

Want me to look at your data?

I run this check for businesses that spend on Meta and Google Ads. Send me a message on LinkedIn with "GA4 audit" and your site, and I'll tell you the first three things I'd look at.

Message me on LinkedIn

Post 2 of 7 in my series on connecting Claude to the tools I use to run ads. Next: Microsoft Clarity.